

Spongebob me boi, PID 4 is the Windows **System** process. It usually means a kernel-mode component, most commonly **HTTP.sys**, owns the listening socket on behalf of another service. netstat alone cannot identify the actual service behind it.

If it is an HTTP/HTTPS port

Run an elevated Command Prompt:

```
1 netsh http show servicestate view=requestq verbose=yes
```

Search the output for the port, URL, or IP address. Look for:

- **Registered URLs**
- **Request queue name**
- **Process IDs**
- **Controller process ID**

The process ID under the request queue often identifies the actual application using HTTP.sys. Microsoft documents this command as showing the current HTTP service state, including sessions and request queues. [\[learn.microsoft.com\]](#), [\[learn.microsoft.com\]](#)

Also check URL registrations:

```
1 netsh http show urlacl
```

For HTTPS, inspect the certificate binding and its application GUID:

```
1 netsh http show sslcert
```

Or inspect one specific binding:

```
1 netsh http show sslcert ipport=0.0.0.0:443
```

The Application ID can help identify which application created the binding. These commands query and manage HTTP.sys configuration. [\[learn.microsoft.com\]](#), [\[learn.microsoft.com\]](#)

Map the resulting PID to a service

Replace 1234 with the process ID from servicestate:

```
1 tasklist /svc /fi "PID eq 1234"
```

PowerShell alternative:

```
1 Get-CimInstance Win32_Service |  
2     Where-Object ProcessId -eq 1234 |  
3     Select-Object Name, DisplayName, State, StartName, PathName
```

For an svchost.exe PID:

```
1 tasklist /svc /fi "PID eq 1234"
```

This displays the Windows services hosted inside that specific svchost.exe.

Quick port-specific workflow

For example, if port 5985 shows PID 4:

```
1 netstat -ano | findstr ":5985"
2 netsh http show servicestate view=requestq verbose=yes
3 netsh http show urlacl | findstr /i "5985"
```

PowerShell makes the initial lookup cleaner:

```
1 Get-NetTCPConnection -LocalPort 5985 -State Listen |
2     Select-Object LocalAddress, LocalPort, OwningProcess
```

If netsh http does not show the port

It may be owned directly by:

- A kernel-mode driver
- SMB/System networking
- RPC
- Another Windows kernel service

Check the common System-owned ports:

```
1 Get-NetTCPConnection -OwningProcess 4 -State Listen |
2     Sort-Object LocalPort |
3     Format-Table LocalAddress, LocalPort
```

Then examine relevant services and drivers:

```
1 sc queryex type= service state= all
2 sc query type= driver state= all
```

For the clearest GUI view, use **Sysinternals TCPView** and **Process Explorer**, run as administrator. However, even these may still show System when the endpoint is genuinely owned in kernel mode.

Best starting command:

```
1 netsh http show servicestate view=requestq verbose=yes
```

That is usually the command that reveals what is sitting behind PID 4.